The Treatise on the Accomplishment of Mercury

Rasaśāstrasiddhi · Toh 4313 · Derge Tengyur

དངྒུ་ཆུ་གྲུབ་པའི་བསྟན་བཅོས་ཞེས་བྱ།

The Treatise on the Accomplishment of Mercury, whose Sanskrit title is transmitted in the Tibetan as Ras śvasta siddhi (probably a corrupted form of Rasaśāstrasiddhi), and known in Tibetan as Dngul chu grub pa'i bstan bcos, is a short treatise on the alchemical and medicinal preparation of mercury. It opens with verses of homage to the Buddha as the omniscient Lord Protector who bestows both worldly enjoyment and liberation. It then praises mercury as a stainless, self-arisen and supreme substance. The text explains that mercury is harmful when adulterated in its processing, but when properly "killed" and prepared by the learned it cures disease, dispels hunger, and is even said to grant the power of moving through the sky. It is Toh 4313 in the Tengyur, where it belongs among the works on medicine and the traditional sciences, reflecting the Indian rasa tradition of alchemy that was transmitted into Tibet alongside Buddhist learning.

In the language of India: ras śvasta siddhi nāma. In the language of Tibet: The Treatise on the Accomplishment of Mercury.

Homage to the Buddha.

To the omniscient one who grants all things,
The form endowed with peace and glory,
The supreme one who cherishes others,
To enjoyment and liberation I bow:
To the glorious Lord Protector.
Liberated from entity and non-entity,
Free from the seen and the unseen,
He bestows enjoyment and liberation.
To the Lord of Glory I bow and offer praise.

Stainless, self-arisen, supreme mercury,
When adulterated in the processes, is said to be harmful;
In other preparations it produces good qualities.
When it is killed, it destroys diseases;
When prepared by the learned, it destroys hunger;
Pursued with longing, it brings the power of moving through the sky.
Through the power of the mica fed to it,

Eightfold qualities are obtained;
When it is combined with sulfur,
Sixfold qualities are obtained.
When combined with gold in equal parts,
One travels unobstructed on the path of the sky.
White tin is fed to it in equal measure;
This process combines silver twofold;
Twice the mercury is combined with water,
And likewise it should be combined with gold.
It pierces sixty-four parts of copper.
Yellowed mercury performs the processes.
When it is brought into contact with fire,
It becomes like a bubble,
And that it is shown to be unmoving
Comes from combining it with mica.
With gold and silver in equal parts
The processes come to be performed.
Then, the mark of the equal measure:
Once the mica has melted,
The mercury is brought under control,
And the doors of Kubera's treasury of gold
Will be thrown open.
The stainless-faced mica
Is bound by fire;
From sulfur it is drawn out.
Liquid that passes into gold,
Mingles into one and fills it,
Is very rare upon this earth.
Without purification it does not succeed:
Because it has not been cooked to red,
It does not turn substances into gold;
Cooked and purified, it succeeds,
And even ten-millionfold transmutation is achieved.

Then I shall tell of the countless substances.
The supreme among them is steel;
There is also another steel, hard to obtain.

Copper, tin, brass and lead,
Purified copper, gold and silver,
And stone-like iron: into these eight
Mercury is to be introduced.
After purifying, the processes are performed;
Cleansed and purified, they are made into elixir.
Sulfur and vimala,
Mākṣika and likewise cinnabar,
Realgar and likewise lead, these six,
And spear-resin and orpiment
Should be purified by one with wisdom;
Knowing them, one performs the processes.
Orpiment performs the processes of gold;
The yellow performs the processes of the white.
Mica together with tisha
Performs the processes of kakuśrī.
Their signs shall now be told;
They should be purified and freed of poison.
Good steel is white,
Keen, and becomes intensely hot.
Copper that is deep red is good;
Of it there are three kinds.
That born in Nepal is good by nature;
The poor kind, when purified, becomes supreme.
That born in Kandha'ur is poor;
The mixture of good and poor performs the processes.
Through purification and repeated purification,
Mercury is made deep red.
Lead is of two kinds, black and white;
By nature it melts quickly, like water.
Brass with much impurity is the best;
By nature it melts quickly, like water.
The second kind also melts quickly;
The white is renowned as supreme.
The yellow has a fine luster like gold;
When burnt, it turns foul-smelling and black;
By strong boiling it is made to melt.

The coarse kind comes from the element of copper;
Since it turns black when burnt,
It melts only slowly.
From mixing it with tin
It becomes the element of bell metal.
Copper by nature is hard to melt;
Bell metal and brass melt quickly.
Gold, when rubbed, is yellow;
When cut, it turns white;
When burnt, it takes on a saffron luster;
A little of it is heavy and oily:
These six are the marks of gold.
Silver is white like the kunda flower,
Oily, lustrous and very bright.
The sixty-four qualities
Are fully present in all the metals.
These have been explained in summary.

Following what was explained before,
First, in explaining steel:
Its purification is done up to seven times.
For the two kinds of keen steel as well,
The gold should be examined with breath held.
Put in salt and purify it!
Further, purify it with the five urines;
Mix the salt and the urine together.
Having cleansed and purified it,
Purify it with sour liquid and burn it intensely.
After doing this many times,
Take its root and burn it!
Again put in sour liquid and purify it.
By such a sequence,
Iron and steel are to be combined.
Add elephant bone,
Take powders of indigo wood,
Mix them with goat's urine,
And purify up to seven times.

With copper purified in this way,
The wise masters who make gold
Combine the copper thus.
Among the eight metals copper is supreme;
It will distinguish all the processes.

Then, to be rightly explained,
I shall explain the rite of purifying brass.
Grind it to powder with a file,
Then grind the powder finely.
Mix in salt and urine;
Dry and burn it up to seven times.
Or else add sour juice
And burn it up to three times.
By cleansing it in this way,
The brass is thoroughly purified.
Then bell metal is to be purified.
Ground finely as before,
Add salt and urine to it;
Pour them in again and again and boil it;
It is purified up to seven times.
Again add sour juice,
Add a little lead and melt it;
By burning, it turns into copper.
By the sequence explained before, copper too is purified.
Purifying bell metal in this way
Is the method of purifying the supreme metal.

As for the purification of lead,
To explain its procedure:
Turmeric ground to powder,
Or else mix in śrīkhaṇḍa sandalwood;
Put in a great deal and let it dry.
Then add the lead and grind it;
Purified up to seven times, it becomes clean.
When the lead has melted,
Add the juice of the three fruits.
By the rite of purifying lead,

White tin too is purified in the same way.
For the nature of realgar,
Purify it with mālatī juice,
Pour it into the ground tin,
And dry and grind it again and again.
Pour in jyotiṣmatī oil;
If there is none, mix it
With the oil of nāraja flowers.
And by many other methods of combining,
All faults are overcome.
Mix in a little black lead:
This is the pure nature of silver.

Thus purify it three times with urine;
Grinding and grinding, wash it three times.
By this it becomes pure and prevails.
I shall now speak of purifying gold.
Purifying with salt is most prized,
And likewise with sour juice.
Mix butter and honey,
Combine them with the gold and grind.
Purify it six times more than for the other operations;
By that it will surely succeed.
Such are the operations of gold.
Next I shall speak of the work with metals.
According to the uses of the different kinds,
What is born in Paṇḍihan is best;
Gold and silver too are best from there.
Take steel just as it is found.
First comes the rite of purification;
Afterward I shall speak of the operations.
Thus the gold-sheen stone
Is purified with salt and sour juice.
Grind it well in an iron vessel,
Cover the metal over with a capsule,
And wrap the edges with cloth and clay.
By roasting it becomes pure;

Roast it until it turns to powder.
This rite of purification
Is to be done for all the operations.
Sulfur the color of butter is good;
The middling, take as it is found, like butter;
The poor resembles an ox's tooth.
Thus there are three kinds of sulfur.
Of vimala, the yellow is good;
By the colors of gold and silver
Know the best and the middling.
Having known them, perform the operations.
The gold-sheen stone, being yellow,
Is by nature of the element of copper;
Brass stone and gold-sheen stone
Are one in element and nature.
Yellow like the color of clouds,
Like the fruit of the karavīra flower:
That is the best.
Purify them knowing the kinds well.
Best, middling, and lowest:
Mākṣika appears in three kinds.
Cinnabar has two kinds:
The best is clear like the light of the sun;
Golden cinnabar, intensely red, is best.
Both are of the element of mercury.
Of realgar, the best has a distinctive smell.
I shall state the marks of vitriol:
The oily and yellow is very good,
Yellow like the back of a golden frog;
If that is not found, take the red.
Once purified, perform the operations.
When ripened it is of the yellow element.
Of orpiment, the very white is good;
The middling is yellowish.
Having known this, apply it to the operations;
For other operations take ordinary yellow too.
Mica is spoken of by the names of the sky.

Of the yellow, the black, and the white,
By melting mica one performs the operations;
By using it properly one performs the operations.
The best is yellow like the color of gold;
Black is of the middling element;
These two are taken for the work of turning into gold.
By purifying the white,
The work of silver too succeeds.
Red cita is best;
The red element is not to be added.
Kaṅkuṣṭha is slightly yellow.
All this has been explained before,
And the eight metals too were explained above.
From combining these through the operations,
From combining and grinding the metals,
One kills them and afterward pierces.
The diamond is born in the land of Paṇṭre.
Native iron, stone iron,
Lead, copper, brass,
New bell metal, and likewise silver:
For all of these and for white tin,
They are to be washed and made clean.
The gold-sheen stone overcomes iron,
And silver and tin are impaired;
The work of gold is pure.
From thoroughly purifying the six metals,
The work of gold succeeds,
And the work of silver will succeed.
Add zima juice;
Purify it with sour juice.
Having ground the tin,
Pour in zima juice again,
And mix in the rind of emblic myrobalan.
Once it is so mixed and ground,
Roast it again inside a capsule;
Then the tin becomes powder.
Mix the powder with orpiment,

And grind the mākṣika well.
Wrap the ground powder in cloth,
Add the juice of black gram,
And dry it in the smoke of a fire.
With the powder of dried cow dung,
Put it in water and fumigate it with the juice.
Mix salt and urine,
And purify its nature up to seven times;
Afterward purify it with sour juice,
And then perform the operations.
Likewise purify vimala too:
By that same rite as before,
Purify it and perform the operations.
I shall explain the operations of sulfur.
In the order explained before,
First grind it well.
In an iron vessel
Mix it thoroughly with butter oil,
And purify its nature on the fire.
With the juice of dhattūra
Mix it three times and dry it.
When the cinnabar has been ground,
Purify it with peacock bile;
If that is not found, with the bile of the roju.
Just as cinnabar is purified,
So the gold-bearing frog's back, realgar,
Orpiment, and the sour stone
Are to be purified in turn with cinnabar.
For frog's back and kaṅkuṣṭha
And mica, the work is done
With the bile of the sokhri fish.
Purify all of them up to seven times,
And wash them in that same order.
I shall speak of purifying mica,
Following what was explained before.
The best is black mica;
It accomplishes the operations of gold.

The white performs the operations of silver;
Joined with mercury it pierces.
Separate the mica into single leaves
And put them in an iron vessel.
Mix in the root of taṅkālu
And soak them in its juice;
Purify them too with the juice
Of the leaves of the silk-cotton tree.
Fumigate them and dry them in the sun;
Grind them and soak them in the former juice.
Then the mica becomes powder.
Once it has been well ground,
Grind it further underfoot.
Wash it again and grind it;
Mix it with the juice of tiktā,
Put it in, and roast it up to three times.
By this rite of purification,
Among black and white mica,
Yellow mica is the best;
It is declared best for the operations of gold.
When it has been cleansed and purified,
Combine mercury with the mica.
Sulfur, the gold-sheen stone, orpiment,
And likewise cinnabar: for these four
I speak of mastering their nature;
They will perform all the operations.
Red and black mica too
Are to be separated into single leaves
And purified by the former rite.
Add the bile of the sokhri fish,
And mix in a little cinnabar.
Put it inside a capsule and seal it,
And roast it fiercely in a charcoal fire;
Roast it until the capsule
Takes on the nature of fire.
When it is roasted with cinnabar added
In a capsule that has an opening,

Without sealing the capsule's mouth,
It melts like the nature of metal.
For the sign of the work of gold,
It is taught to be done in this way.
White mica proves true;
By working with this, all is known.
For the work of silver it is likewise.
For the purification of the gold-sheen stone,

Again, purify it thoroughly with sour substances.
In a vessel made of iron or of clay,
fill it up with sour powder.
The iron lumps are to be killed.
Steep them well in sour juice.
Mercury is treated in the same way:
by carrying out that procedure
the mercury can be made into pills.
Again, put in the sour substance.
Inside a vessel made of clay,
cover it from above with another clay vessel.
Then smear the outside with clay,
and wrap the clay-smeared vessel in cloth.
Add a little water as well.
After that, heat it from below with fire.
The mercury will collect at the top.
Gather up the mercury at the top;
the mercury that remains will dry up.
This apparatus is the pātana apparatus.
When the wise have ground these together,
the gold-sheen stone stays at the bottom.
Mix it with cinnabar and with sour substances.
As in the other preparations,
this is done by the method of the sealed crucible with no opening.
To fix the gold-sheen stone,
by roasting it, it is obtained at the bottom.
Once it is truly accomplished in a single day,
for the signs of the gold work,

the operations with cinnabar are now to be stated.
In the procedure for making it true,
first grind it finely.
Mix it well with sour juice.
By the pātaka preparation,
truly draw it in and bring it under control.
Just as mercury does with silver,
it will penetrate in the gold work.
The nature of orpiment is now to be stated,
and the operations for making it true and drawing it in are told.
Separate it all, layer by layer, into its flakes.
Grind good orpiment into powder
and mix it with the bile of the sokhri fish.
The wise will understand it in this way.
Then mix it with borax powder
and grind everything together.
Over the iron, cover it with an iron lid.
The small flakes, pure and true,
are also to be ground into powder
and placed inside the sealed crucible with no opening.
When it has dried, roast it thoroughly.
Without doubt it becomes true,
and it will be seen to be white in color.
For the signs of the silver work,
the procedure of purification is now to be stated.
When mercury is purified and penetrates,
the aims of a person's mind,
Dharma, action and benefit, are accomplished,
just as the welfare of one's own body
is accomplished by mercury.
The steadfast one does not give the supreme mercury
to ordinary people.
Mix and grind brick powder,
kara poison and mustard seed,
combined with the three hot spices,
likewise seeds steeped in liquor,
and the dungda found on khampa:

these are the eleven kinds.
The potent one is named ragna.
Mix them all together.
Mix all of these with mercury,
wash it, and grind the mercury.
Grind it again and again;
in three days it will be purified.
Fill it to about a hundred sang.
Of that, take fifty sang,
and half of that, twenty-five sang.
If one cannot prepare that much,
it can be done even with two sang.
For the procedure of binding mercury,
the potent herbs are now to be stated:
Brahmā's staff,
likewise Brahmā's moon,
the one named snake's eye,
likewise the yellow sun's eye,
likewise cuckoo root,
likewise mandhuparṇī,
and also the leaves of śalinci,
the herb of great strength,
and the bashful flower:
these are the most precious herbs.
The herb that dries up water
is said to be the moon-throne tree;
with it all the operations are done.
Bhūta's locks, the great-leaved,
jotismati, one kind of sma,
hatrakubhi milk,
likewise camel thorn,
the radiant peacock's crest,
likewise the red purgative,
and the one called nāga's strength:
these perform the operations on silver.
Kubera is declared to be supreme.
These bind the water.

The kinds that have been stated in this way
are what bind the water.
From the herbs that have been stated,
gather whatever is available.
The wise and intelligent should take them up.
Whatever purifies is sour.
Purify it thoroughly with brass stone
and fumigate it over a very small fire;
it is through the fumes that it matures.
Keep grinding and fumigating it
for a period of seven days.

Then mix it with the medicines and grind it.
For the work with the medicines, as they are found,
take the juices of all the medicines,
and by the instructions as they have been stated
perform the rite of the sour preparation.
Do the same also with oil.
Into the preparation of oil and sour
the mercury should be put.
That too is smoked over a slight fire.
Again and again put it in and dry it.
What is to be stated next:
by stating it, success comes with ease.
What is to be done slowly in this way
is dried by the rite given before.

Maṇi leaves, the varuṇa tree,
nirkrun fragrance and mahārasatri,
poison, and likewise śatri,
ghani and hari likewise,
Brahmā's staff and dhadura,
poison, black mustard and citraka,
tongue-piercer and the other medicines:
of these, take whatever is found.
Take them slowly by the rite of the sour.
The intoxicant, likewise laṅkali,
and also the white karavīra,

the intoxicant and śikru:
these are held to be the minor poisons.

The five great poisons are also to be stated:
sāthuba and sringiba,
kālakūṭa, the tawny one,
and the poison like yellow honey.
Sea salt and saindhava,
borax and sal ammoniac,
and excrement salt: five kinds.
Tshalam tshur and zetsha:
these are the three transformers.

Pyrites, the stainless stone,
thuthuka and mercury,
the mover and cinnabar,
and masaka: the seven essences.
Orpiment and realgar,
the sour one and sulphur,
frog-back stone and kāśika,
and the leaf: these are the seven secondary essences.

Palāśa and the kata's
avamara and kahi grove,
the stalk of pippali,
and the tree that bears alkali,
and also the three transformers;
cow, elephant and she-camel:
thus the three kinds of urine;
ginger and likewise kasduka,
the red citraka,
turmeric and likewise madder,
red sandalwood and pataṃka,
kusumbha and leaf silver:
these are the medicines for cooking mercury,
gathered as the red group.

The oil of jitismati,
karañja and atasī:

thus the three groups of oils
are what make mercury shine.
Likewise the wood of bheśa
should be dried in the sun.
Add the juice of lotus leaves.
All the wood of bhogana,
and likewise conch powder,
alkali and the group of urines,
salt and likewise the secondary salts,
the supreme group of medicines,
sindhu salt and the sour:
within the sour, suspended in midair,
the mercury should be cooked.
On the leaves of mandhuka
put the juice and cook it;
this is what removes impurities.
This apparatus is blazing fire.
Into the haṃsapāka apparatus
it should be poured all at once.
Add sindhu salt and cinnabar too,
and pour it into a copper vessel,
in an apparatus without an opening.
With a very smooth apparatus,
day after day, as is proper,
add the tawny poison and the sour.
Dry it as with the fierce crow.
By the drying rite explained before, the medicine
is sixteen times the mercury.
The subdued metals should be put in;
the mercury will consume them all.
Afterwards grind the white mercury
and make everything into one.

Steel, and likewise the other sharp metal,
add lead and brass;
afterwards the mercury should be put in.
Mix copper and lead together.

Bell metal and brass
serve to bind the mercury.
By killing steel the mercury is bound.
Mercury consumes gold threefold,
and that rids it of impurities.
Pyrites and steel, the two,
are what dry the mercury.
The application of the mercury's work is accomplished.
Common luster likewise:
from mixing all of it in equal parts,
by the application of its work,
the works of the six metals are applied.
With pyrites the works are accomplished;
by it the supreme works are accomplished.
The jewel seed should be added;
it then turns into half gold.
With two rounds it turns white.
Again, to the killed steel,
by combining it with double silver,
the mercury is perfected.
Once it is dried like gold,
all aims are accomplished.

It transmutes thirty-two,
fifty, a hundred, five hundred, a thousand;
it transmutes up to ten thousand and a hundred thousand.
One who knows this work
accomplishes the elixirs and rejuvenations.
In one month, the measure of many doses
grants long life and great strength;
one will live up to a hundred thousand years.
By eating twice that amount
one becomes like one sixteen years old.
It destroys the eight diseases, leprosy and the rest.
From eating a great deal in this way
one lives as long as sun, moon and stars remain.
It removes all white hair and wrinkles,

and has every good quality by nature.

Here, having understood the meanings
from the treatises on mercury,
this was composed by Bhālipa.
May the aims of all be accomplished!

The treatise on the perfect accomplishment of mercury, composed by the great master Bhālipa, is complete.

It was translated by the Indian paṇḍita Śrī Narendrabhadra and the Tibetan translator Orgyenpa Rinchen Pal at the great palace on the slope of the great mountain Budtra.

Translator's Notes

• The metal and mineral identifications follow standard Indian alchemical usage: lhang tsher as mica, mu zi as sulfur, gsha' tshe as tin, zha nye and klu (Sanskrit nāga, a common alchemical name for lead) both as lead, rag na as brass, 'khar ba as bell metal, rno lcags as steel, ldong ros as realgar, ba bla as orpiment, ba tsha as salt. The rendering of the substance ti tsha (as "tisha"), the process kakuśrī, the place Kandha'ur, the flower nāraja and "spear-resin" (mdung rtsi) are uncertain; they are transliterated or translated literally.

In the opening verse, zho ba is read as zhi ba, "peace." Several evident slips are translated by their plain readings: rdzes for rdzas ("substances"), spangs for sbyangs ("purify"), skyar po for skyur po ("sour"), nes pa for nyes pa ("faults") and 'doms for 'joms ("overcome").

The line rendered "pursued with longing" (brkams pas) may stand for "bound" (bcings pas), which would match the standard alchemical sequence of swooned, killed and bound mercury.
• This is an alchemical (rasaśāstra) text, so □□ is rendered "operations" or "work" rather than "karma," and □□□□□ means "yellow" here. The identity of several mineral and plant names is uncertain. "Gold-sheen stone" translates □□□□□□□□□□□□ literally; it may correspond to a pyrite such as mākṣika or rasaka. "Frog's back" translates □□□□□□□□ literally. "Zima," "roju," "sokhri fish," "taṅkālu," "Paṇḍihan," and "Paṇṭre" (possibly Puṇḍra) are given as spelled because I could not identify them with confidence. "Tin" for □□□□□□ and "vitriol" for □□□□ are probable identifications. "Made clean" reads □□□□□□ as □□□□□□. "Cinnabar" in "purified in turn with cinnabar" and "mix in a little cinnabar" reads □□ as □□□.
• This is an alchemical manual on mercury, so terms such as "kill," "bind," "make true," "draw in" and "penetrate" are technical operations: calcining, fixing, stabilizing, and transmuting metals. "Water" in the binding section refers to mercury. "Bhāta'ng" and "pātaka" are rendered as pātana, the sublimation apparatus and procedure, which is a probable but not certain identification. "Gsersil stone" (gold-sheen stone) is probably pyrite (svarṇamākṣika). "Chal" is read as mtshal, cinnabar, as in the following lines. "Ba bla" is taken as orpiment, "tsha la" as borax, and "phyi ma" as phye ma, "powder." "Kha med ga'u," the sealed crucible with no opening, probably corresponds to the "blind crucible" (andhamūṣā).

Several substance and plant names could not be identified with confidence and are translated literally or transcribed: be rags (iron lumps), sokhri fish, kara poison, the dungda on khampa,

ragna, Brahmā's moon, snake's eye, sun's eye, cuckoo root, moon-throne tree, sma, hatrakubhi, the red purgative, and brass stone. Some likely correspond to Sanskrit plant names, such as brahmadaṇḍī for Brahmā's staff, lajjālu for the bashful flower, mayūraśikhā for peacock's crest, nāgabalā for nāga's strength, bhūtakeśī for bhūta's locks, and mahābalā for the herb of great strength.

"Mi g.yo ba" is read as "the steadfast one," not as the deity Acala; the line is ambiguous. "Kubera" here may designate a plant or substance named after the god.
• Many plant, mineral and salt names are Tibetan sound-spellings of Sanskrit drug names whose identity is uncertain; they have been kept close to the Tibetan spelling. Examples are nirkrun, mahārasatri, śatri, ghani, kasduka, bheśa, bhogana, mandhuka and the "kata's avamara and kahi grove." Some identifications are plausible but not certain: "Brahmā's staff" as brahmadaṇḍī, dhadura as dhattūra, laṅkali as lāṅgalī, śikru as śigru, sāthuba and sringiba as vatsanābha and śṛṅgika, and the "three transformers" as the three alkalis.

"Haṃsapāka apparatus" reads □□□□□□□□□□□ as ngang pas smin pa ("cooked by the haṃsa"), which matches the known alchemical haṃsapāka yantra.

The meaning of □□□□□□□□□□□ is uncertain; it is rendered "poured all at once." "As with the fierce crow" is a literal rendering of an obscure phrase.

In the line on elixirs, □□□ ("ten") has been taken as a slip for □□□□ ("elixir").

The author's name, spelled bhā li ba, may correspond to the alchemist Vyāḍi, but this is not certain.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.